

THE OLD TESTAMENT FOR EVERYONE

John Goldingay

Genesis Chapter 1

1At the beginning of God's creating the heavens and the earth, 2 when the earth was an empty void, with darkness over the face of the deep, and God's breath sweeping over the face of the water, 3 God said, 'Light!' and light came into being. 4 God saw that light was good, and God made a distinction between light and darkness. 5 God called the light 'day'; the darkness he called 'night'. And there was evening and there was morning, day one.

6God said, 'A dome in the middle of the water to make water distinct from water!' 7And God made the dome and made a distinction between the water that was under the dome and the water that was above the dome. So it came to be. 8God called the dome 'heav-ens'. And there was evening and there was morning, a second day.

9God said, 'The water under the heavens is to come together into one place so the dry land may appear!' So it came to be. 10God called the dry land 'earth'; the coming together of water he called 'seas'. God saw that it was good.

11God said, 'The earth is to put forth vegetation: plants generating seed, fruit trees producing fruit by its species, with its seed in it, on the earth!' So it came to be. 12The earth brought forth vegetation, plants generating seed by its species, and trees producing fruit with its seed in it by its species.

God saw that it was good. 13And there was evening and there was morning, a third day.

Filling in the outline (days four to six)

14God said, 'Lights in the dome of the heavens to make a distinction between day and night! They'll be for signs and set times and days and years, 15and they'll be lights in the dome of the heavens to give light on the earth!' So it came to be. 16God made the two big lights (the bigger light to rule the day and the smaller light to rule the night) and the stars. 17God put them in the dome of the heavens to give light on the earth, 18to rule over the day and over the night, and to make a distinction between light and darkness. God saw that it was good. 19And there was evening and there was morning, a fourth day.

20God said, 'The water is to teem with living crea-tures, and birds are to fly over the earth, over the face of the dome of the heavens!' 21God created the big sea monsters and every living creature that moves, with which the water teems, by their species, and every winged bird by its species. God saw that it was good.

22God blessed them: 'Be fruitful, be numerous, fill the water in the seas; birds are to be numerous on the earth.'

23And there was evening and there was morn-ing, a fifth day.

24God said, 'The earth is to bring forth living creatures by their species - animals, moving things and the living things of the earth, by their species!' So it came to be. 25God made the living things of the earth by their species, animals by their species and all the things that move on the ground by their species. God saw that it was good.

The week's work completed

26God said, 'Let's make human beings in our image, as our likeness, so they can hold sway over the fish in the sea, over the birds in the heavens, over the animals, over all the earth and over all the things that move on the earth. 27So God created human beings in his image. He created them in the image of God.

He created them male and female. 28God blessed them, and said to them, 'Be fruitful, be numerous, fill the earth and subjugate it, hold sway over the fish in the sea, over the birds in the heavens and over every creature that moves on the earth.'

29God said, 'Here, I give you all the plants that generate seed that are on the face of all the earth, and every tree with fruit that generates seed. These will be food for you, 30for all the creatures of the earth, for all the birds in the heavens and for all the things that move on the earth that have living breath in them, all the green plants as food. So it came to be.

31God saw all that he had made, and there - it was very good. And there was evening and there was morning, the sixth day.